

Getting Ready for Development

Setting Up Your Tools & Environment — In-Class Discovery Worksheet

Name: _____ Section: _____ Date: _____

How to use this sheet: Work through each "Try This" setup step on your own laptop as you reach it. For every question, **attempt and write your answer *before* we discuss it.**

Part 1 — Necessary Applications

TRY THIS - VS CODE

Install **VS Code** on your laptop. Search `install vscode` on Google and download the version for your operating system.

Q1. What is an **IDE**? Why do you need one?

Q2. Do you know any other IDEs besides VS Code? Name them.

TRY THIS - CHROME SETUP

Download **Google Chrome** (if you don't already have it) and make it your default browser. This will be our common browser throughout the course for visualizing and debugging.

Hint: Open Chrome → Settings → **Default browser** (left panel), then follow the steps there.

Q3. What other browser do you prefer besides Google Chrome? Why?

Q4. Do you know how to switch **Chrome Profiles**?

Q5. Do you know any recent Chrome features, like **tab grouping** or **split view**?

TRY THIS - WSL (WINDOWS ONLY)

To use Linux commands (the developer's OS), Windows users need **WSL** — the Windows Subsystem for Linux. **macOS users can skip this step.** Search `install wsl for windows` on Google; it will point you to running `wsl --install` in PowerShell or Command Prompt **as an administrator**. Follow the steps, then confirm it worked by running `uname` — it should print the operating system name.

Note: Windows and Linux use completely different system architectures, so Windows cannot natively run Linux command-line tools — WSL bridges that gap. macOS doesn't need it, because macOS is built on a **Unix foundation** and already shares the same core command-line tools, file paths, and developer utilities that Linux uses.

Part 2 — Beyond the Syllabus

Q6. Given a situation where you need to handle multiple applications at once, how do you do that? Have you already discovered the **three-** and **four-finger** gestures for switching between apps?

Q7. (Windows specific) Do you know about **Clipboard History**? It's one of the magical features you'd miss on a Mac.

Q8. (MacBook specific) Does your backspace or arrow keys feel slow? Is your cursor movement speed optimized?

Q9. Do you know how to use native **voice typing** on your laptop?

Q10. How do you directly open your terminal / command prompt in any folder you see in Finder / File Explorer?

Q11. How do you take a screenshot of only a **selected portion** of your screen, and paste it into a chat / WhatsApp without any extra clicks?